

Meeting Notes: Project Atlas Post-Migration Review

Date: April 22, 2026 | Attendees: Priya Chandrasekaran, Marcus Webb, Wallace Okafor, Alex Kim (Security)

Context

Six weeks after migrating Project Atlas's similarity search to the vector database per RFC-019, the team reconvened to review production results before the final Postgres decommission step.

Findings

Query latency did improve as expected (p95 down to 45ms). However, Alex Kim flagged a security incident during the review period: the row-level security policies that previously gated item visibility by user permissions were not being enforced in the new vector database layer, since it has no native concept of Postgres RLS. Two users briefly saw recommendations for items outside their account's visibility scope before the issue was caught in staging.

Decision

The team decided to reverse course on fully decommissioning Postgres for Project Atlas. Instead, embeddings will remain in the vector database for speed, but every result will be re-filtered against Postgres permission tables before being returned to the user, restoring the security guarantee at the cost of some of the latency gains (p95 now approximately 120ms, still a significant improvement over the original 900ms).

Follow-ups

Wallace Okafor to implement the permission re-filtering layer by May 15. Marcus Webb to update RFC-019 with an addendum documenting this change. Alex Kim to add an automated test catching cross-account data leakage before the next migration of this kind.